

Friday 6th September 2013

Newsletter No. 4

**SEMESTER 1-
TERM 1**

Highlights –

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- **Gokulashtami – Lord Krishna's Birthday and its significance**
- **PYP4W News**
- **PYP4R – Differentiate Between Ethical and Unethical**

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- **MYP5 Results**
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- **Community & Service – Our Trip to Snehalaya**
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Lower School:



Preschool

Gokulashtami (Lord Krishna's Birthday) and its significance

Mrs. Sanghavi, a parent of PS3, came to class to speak about the significance of Gokulashtami (Krishna's Birthday) on 28th Aug 2013.

She gave children a presentation about what Lord Krishna likes and how everybody loves him. She also showed a clipping of how it is celebrated. She had also prepared an

activity for the children which they enjoyed- making a crown that Lord Krishna wears and a Birthday card for him. The children enjoyed wearing their crowns and decorating their card.

-Anjali Dias and Shanti Iyer

Primary Years Programme

PYP4W News



We created mind maps together to inquire into our values. We used these values and the PYP attitudes to create our class Essential Agreements. In Maths we have created some of our own Probability games with dice and we continue to conduct surveys and create graphs. We have been watching the interesting story of Ramayan during library time as part of our inquiry into beliefs. This week we have also been reading quite a bit about beliefs throughout the world and how beliefs influence behavior. Miss Bebb read a story to us this week about the concept perspective. We shared our own perspectives of what it was like to be a new student in a school.

- Mr. Garrett Walsh and Ms. Archana Karve

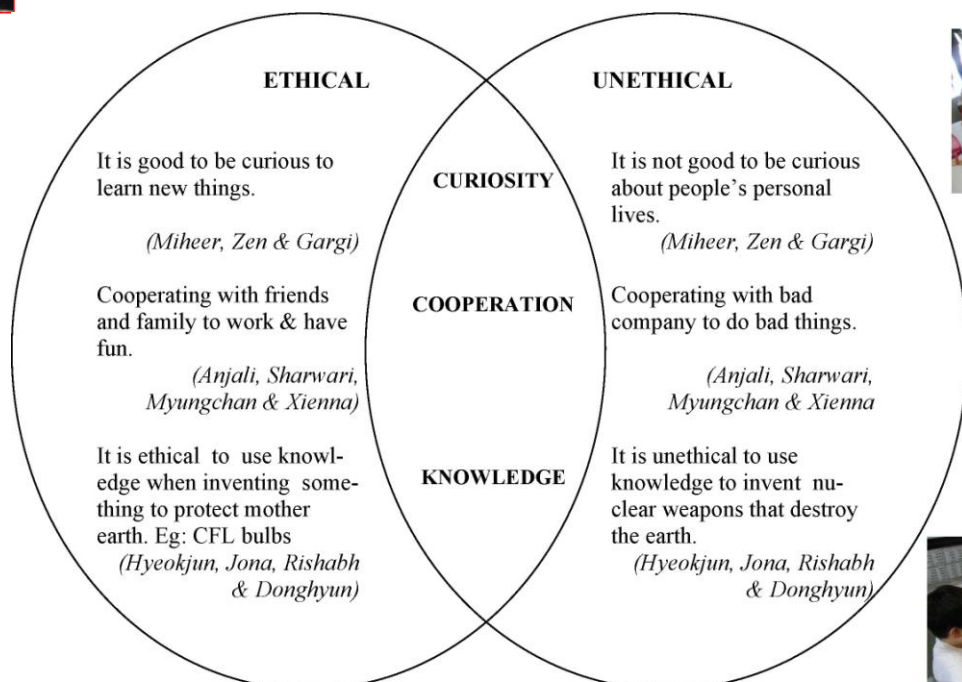


PYP4R Differentiate Between Ethical and Unethical

In keeping with the current unit "Who we are", this week PYP4R did a group activity in UOI to differentiate between

ethical & unethical beliefs. Below are a few examples of how children perceive some of their beliefs as ethical and unethical.

-Michelle Roxburgh and Maryln D'souza



Secondary School:

Middle Years Programme

MYP5 Results

We are pleased to inform you that IB has released the MYP5 results on 1st September. 88% of the candidates received above 36 points. Congratulations to all the students, parents and teachers who have been a part of this whole process. To inform you further, 25 candidates were registered for the session 2012-13. The highest points awarded to a candidate were 49 (Anne Marie), followed by Aninditaa (48) and Anton (47). The results have been released online and a hard copy is provided to students. The Certificates and Records of Achievement will reach us in a couple of weeks from the IB Office. This will be sent home with students as soon as we receive it.

-Meeta Varma

Snake Visit – MYP2

On September 3rd, the MYP2 English classes received a guest speaker. Actually, there were many guests who arrived to see them; however, it was only Mr. Rashid who spoke. Mr. Rashid came to show the MYP2s some of our serpentine friends. In MYP2 English, we are studying short stories, and recently read the Rudyard Kipling story: *Rikki-Tikki-Tavi*. It is a short story about how a mongoose protects a family from cobras. After reading, analyzing, discussing, researching snakes, and making



story boards for the story, Mr. Rashid brought a variety of snakes into the classroom for the students to gain hands-on experience. At first, students asked prepared questions to enhance their knowledge about snakes, then, small, non-venomous snakes were passed around the class, every student taking his or her turn to see and feel a snake. Then a much larger rat snake emerged, coiled its way around students and teacher alike, and then safely returned to its domain. Mr. Rashid also

brought some poisonous snakes (safely contained), including a baby cobra to show the class. Students will now write up a report on what they saw and what they learned. Thank you very much, Mr. Rashid, for making the literature come alive!

-Philip Pflugbeil and Carmela Mandaglio



Community & Service – Our Trip to Snehalaya

The Snehalaya trip was indeed a great experience. The original concept was quite intimidating we must admit, but the smiles we saw on the faces of the children were proof enough we had done the right thing. Upon our arrival we were split into two different groups, one being the volunteer scribes and one the general volunteers. Here is a first-hand account of the experience with the children: At first we were nervous to enter, and to meet the children. We looked at them, and they looked at us, and for a moment there was silence, but then, to break the deadlock, we

approached them with the intent of starting a conversation. They spoke English quite well, although some of them didn't even want to talk, they just wanted to play. And so whether it was soccer, or cricket, or even just catch, we interacted.

Some of the children inside were playing board games; and took kindly to our presence, when we finally did speak. We learnt their names, their hobbies, their age, and much more. We found that they were just like us; and that though they might not have all of our physical capabilities, they could do lots of things that we couldn't. At the end we were sad to have to go; and they were sad to see us leave, but it felt good to give these children a good time, as well as ourselves.



they were unable to write themselves required scribes to be their hands for a day or two. As a result a few students from MBIS have volunteered; this was the first meeting in which we got the chance to socially interact and bond with them before the exam. Our first meeting was very beneficial and quite eventful; it gave us the opportunity to adjust ourselves to our buddy's speech and thought process so that we would be able to accurately convey the intended message. We started by glancing through their current work and going through a little bit of it with them.



Here is another account from one of the scribing volunteers: In the beginning we had no idea what to expect, would they be friendly? Would they be able to express themselves? How prepared would they be? But I guess I should probably explain first. A few students from Snehalaya wanted to take their 10th grade NIOS exams and as





Later during the session a few practice workbooks were handed out with the format and a few questions in the style of the actual exam. Which we all went through and had a



little mock session. By the time we were done with that our time was already up. We felt a little resentful that we couldn't continue, but we took heart in the fact that this was just one of many such trips.

-Aditya and Pranav (MYP 4)



Diploma Programme

University Visits and Presentations at MBIS

Tuesday September 17th

- KICUnivAssist: 10:00 -11:00

Wednesday September 25th – Timings to be determined

- Bryn Mawr University
- Brandeis University
- Lafayette University

(These are TOP U.S. schools)



News from the Boarding:

Snippets ...!!

Trek To Rohida Fort

Saturday was a glorious day, though a little hot for a strenuous walk!

The destination was the Rohida Fort, some 60 kms south west of Pune.

9 students, 2 adults, Ashok one of the school drivers, a guide and the black Labrador, Guinness climbed and clambered up to the fort where we enjoyed our tasty picnic lunch and clear 360 degree views of the surrounding verdant landscape.
An enjoyable outing!
-Rashid & Jan Ali



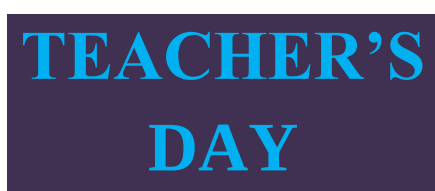
Whole School:

Cyber Bullying and the Precautionary Measures

As the school psychologist, I am getting some serious concerns about cyber bullying. A website called **ask.fm** is being misused by a lot of our students to send inappropriate and mean messages to each other. These messages can be sent anonymously as well. As a school we take bullying of any kind especially cyber bullying very seriously and have a zero tolerance policy for the same.

We have banned this site and many other sites of this nature in school but unfortunately we have no control over students and what they do in their free time. This is our sincere request as a school to please keep an eye on what your children are putting on the world wide forum. We will continue to address the same issue in PHSE lessons.

Thank you
-Barkha Bajaj



Teacher's Day is a very special day for appreciation of teachers. It is celebrated on different days varying from country to country. In India Teachers Day is celebrated on the birthday of Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan's who was a professor of philosophy at many universities in England and India. He was

elected as the first Vice President of India in 1952 and as the second President of India (1962). At this time some of his students and friends requested him to allow them to celebrate his birthday to which he replied:

"Instead of celebrating my birthday, it would be my proud privilege if 5 September is observed as Teachers' Day."

His birthday has since been celebrated as Teachers' Day in India. This is the primary reason why countries celebrate this day on different dates, unlike many other International Days.

I would like to thank the Student Council, Kabir & Shivani, Art for Cause club members, MYP4 & MYP3 art students who created the customized cards for

everyone and the painting in the cafeteria. Big thanks to Ms. Jan Ali and Mr. Ranade for organizing the pots and making sure they are placed in every classroom just in time!!! And lastly I would like to thank Mr. Michael Thompson and Ms. Debbie Coomber for making this happen.

DRESINA is the plant's name placed in every class, it will be maintained by the Gardening staff, getting a few hours of sunshine once in a week.

A Quote from Ms. Jennifer Bhide: Quote

A flower garden is good medicine for a troubled mind. It provides the valuable gift of solitude and helps you focus on the present moment.

Unquote

-Mersedeh Fard

Important Dates

I am aware that you've been informed earlier regarding the important dates; however, I would again like to draw your attention to the following below:

SCHOOL CLOSED:

- Monday September 9th 2013 – School will be closed due to Ganesh Chaturthi
- Wednesday September 18th 2013 – School will be closed due to Ganapati Visarjan (Lord Ganesha Immersion Ceremony)

EARLY CLOSURE:

- Monday September 30th 2013 – Students leave at 12:00 noon. Staff in school for the Professional Development until 4:00 p.m.
- Friday November 29th 2013 - Students leave at 12:00 noon. Staff in school for the Professional Development until 4:00 p.m.

PARENT TEACHER ASSOCIATION – NEXT MEETING AT MBIS:

- Monday September 16th 2013 – Next PTA Meeting - 3:00 p.m. at MBIS

-Poonam Chandiramani